

DHARMA

Constitution DC-3.0

Founding Charter — Private Founder Draft

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Status: Confidential — Internal Working Draft

Capability does not constitute authority.

Preamble

Human civilization built laws for people, contracts for organizations, and protocols for computers. Dharma begins from a different premise: autonomous systems are becoming actors, and actors require legitimate authority.

The purpose of this Constitution is to define the principles that should govern authority across AI agents, enterprise systems, payment networks, APIs, robots, and future machine ecosystems.

Dharma does not replace transport protocols, identity systems, or human law. It proposes a constitutional layer that determines whether an action should legitimately happen before capability is allowed to produce real-world consequences.

Founder's Oath

I build Dharma with the belief that power without legitimate authority creates instability. I will preserve human intent, constrain machine action, produce evidence worthy of trust, and ensure every future version remains faithful to Principle 0.

Principle 0 — The First Law

Capability does not constitute authority.

This principle separates Dharma from purely capability-based systems. A machine may possess the technical ability to spend money, sign a document, control a robot, or invoke an API, yet none of those capabilities automatically grant legitimate authority.

Every future constitutional amendment, protocol extension, SDK, or enterprise implementation should remain compatible with this principle.

Article I — Nature of Authority

Authority answers 'what may legitimately happen', while identity answers 'who is acting'.

- Authority is an independent constitutional concept rather than a synonym for identity.
- Every authority should have an identifiable origin (provenance).
- Authority should be granted intentionally rather than inferred from capability.
- Authority should remain traceable throughout its lifecycle.

Article II — Delegation

Instead of treating permissions as isolated flags, Dharma treats delegation as a constitutional relationship.

- Authority may be delegated to another actor.
- Delegation creates lineage.
- No descendant authority should exceed the authority from which it was derived.
- Every delegation should preserve ancestry.

Article III — Constraints

Constraints become part of authority itself rather than external validation rules.

- Time
- Money
- Geography
- Counterparty
- Risk
- Resource
- Organization
- Protocol Context

Article IV — Intent

Separating intent from execution prevents later systems from manufacturing authority merely because an action appears useful.

- Intent explains why an action exists.
- Inference may recommend.
- Authority decides.
- Intent should remain distinguishable from execution.

Article V — Effects

A payment request that silently purchases additional services should be evaluated against the original authority rather than merely validating the API call.

- Evaluate the final effect rather than only the request.
- Detect authority expansion.
- Preserve consequence awareness.

Article VI — Revocation

Revocation is treated as a first-class constitutional capability.

- Authority must remain revocable.
- Descendant authorities should respect revocation.
- Revocation should preserve constitutional consistency.

Article VII — Evidence

Evidence becomes constitutional memory.

- Issuer
- Recipient
- Delegation Chain
- Constraints
- Intent
- Action
- Effect
- Timestamp

Article VIII — Identity

Identity establishes participants. Authority establishes legitimacy.

- Identity should never automatically become authority.
- Verified identity alone is insufficient.
- Identity and authority should remain separate constitutional layers.

Article IX — Conflict

Future constitutional procedures may define deterministic conflict resolution without violating Principle 0.

- User vs Enterprise
- Enterprise vs Regulator
- Emergency Authority
- Competing Delegations

Article X — Universality

Dharma is designed as a protocol-agnostic constitutional layer.

- MCP
- A2A
- HTTP APIs
- Payment Systems
- Robotics
- Enterprise Platforms

Annexure A — The Six-Layer Model

Identity

Who are you?

Authority

What may you do?

Intent

Why should this action happen?

Action

What was requested?

Effect

What actually happened?

Evidence

Can it later be proven?

The six-layer model is intended to become a recurring architectural lens for evaluating every future Dharma feature.

Annexure B — Authority Object (Conceptual Draft)

The Authority Object is proposed as Dharma's foundational protocol primitive. Rather than freezing the wire format prematurely, this annexure defines the conceptual fields expected to exist.

- **authority_id** — conceptual field for future technical specification.
- **issuer** — conceptual field for future technical specification.
- **subject** — conceptual field for future technical specification.
- **purpose** — conceptual field for future technical specification.
- **scope** — conceptual field for future technical specification.
- **constraints** — conceptual field for future technical specification.
- **delegation_rules** — conceptual field for future technical specification.
- **validity** — conceptual field for future technical specification.
- **revocation_reference** — conceptual field for future technical specification.
- **evidence_pointer** — conceptual field for future technical specification.

Annexure C — Authority Graph

Illustrative lineage:

Human → Agent A → Agent B → Agent C → Action → Effect

Every descendant authority remains bounded by the originating authority. The constitutional purpose of the graph is to preserve ancestry rather than merely recording execution order.

Annexure D — Threat Model

Dharma is intended to address authority-centric risks that become more important as AI agents coordinate.

- Prompt-injection privilege escalation
- Confused deputy attacks
- Replay of delegated authority
- Compromised sub-agents
- Unauthorized effect expansion

This annexure intentionally describes the constitutional direction rather than prescribing cryptographic mechanisms before the technical specification is finalized.

Annexure E — Prior-Art Register

Dharma deliberately acknowledges existing work rather than assuming novelty everywhere.

Mandato — Signed mandates and runtime enforcement.

MCP — Tool connectivity between models and external systems.

A2A — Agent-to-agent communication.

Visa Trusted Agent Protocol — Agent commerce.

OAuth — Authorization.

Google Zanzibar — Large-scale authorization.

NPCI Agent Registry — Payment ecosystem identity.

The purpose of this annexure is to identify the constitutional layer that remains unclaimed rather than ignoring prior art.

Annexure F — Patent Families (Working Titles)

DP-001 — Authority Lineage Engine

DP-002 — Constraint Propagation

DP-003 — Intent-to-Effect Verification

DP-004 — Cross-Protocol Authority Translation

DP-005 — Evidence Graph

DP-006 — Authority Revocation Propagation

DP-007 — Authority Conflict Resolution

These remain invention families rather than finalized patent claims.

Annexure G — Governance Roadmap

- Founder's Ledger
- Constitution
- Prior-Art Map
- Authority Object Specification
- Patent Strategy
- Reference Implementation
- Developer SDK
- Pilot Integrations
- Public Whitepaper

Each stage represents an evolution of Dharma rather than a promise of adoption.

Constitutional Commitment

Every future Dharma protocol, SDK, verification engine, enterprise platform, governance mechanism, and implementation should remain compatible with Principle 0 unless amended through future constitutional procedures.

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